

News Briefs

Sun acquires Q-layer

The Q-layer organisation, which is based in Belgium, will become part of Sun's cloud computing business unit that develops and integrates cloud computing technologies, architectures and services. According to Sun, the Q-layer technology simplifies cloud management and allows users to quickly provision and deploy applications, a key component in Sun's strategy to enable building public and private clouds. For more information, check out sun.com/cloud.

Greg Symon joins Red Hat

Red Hat has named Greg Symon as the vice president and general manager of North American sales. With more than 25 years of business and sales experience, Symon will play a key leadership role in the development and execution of Red Hat's North American sales strategy and growth, the company said.

Symon held various senior sales management and business development positions during a 22-year tenure with the Intel Corporation.

vxVistA to be released under EPL

DSS, Inc. will open the source code for its vxVistA electronic health record (EHR) framework. With this, DSS has effectively removed the greatest obstacle to collaboration in the VistA community by providing the enhanced version of VistA under a commercially-friendly open source licence—Eclipse Public Licence—that can be used to unite the VistA community.

Alan Cox leaves Red Hat for Intel

After 10 years as a kernel developer at Red Hat, Alan Cox has finally bid farewell to the open source vendor. In an e-mail dated December 23, 2008, with a subject line, "Moving on from Red Hat" to the editors of L.Xer.com, Cox wrote, "I will be



departing Red Hat mid-January having handed in my notice... I'm leaving on good terms and strongly supporting the work Red Hat is doing. I've been at Red Hat for ten years as contractor and employee, and now have an opportunity to get even closer to the low level stuff that interests me most. Barring last minute glitches, I shall be relocating to Intel (logically at least, physically I'm not going anywhere) and still be working on Linux and free software stuff."

Although Cox is leaving on good terms with Red Hat, as indicated in his e-mail: "I know some people will wonder what it means for Red Hat engineering. Red Hat has a solid, world class, engineering team and my departure will have no effect on their ability to deliver." But his reason for leaving the company—"to get even closer to the low level stuff"—makes us wonder about the shift of focus of the Linux vendor. It seems like they are more focused on the applications stack now. However, this doesn't mean Red Hat is likely to abandon its focus on kernel development any time soon.

SCO announces the auctioning of two business divisions

The SCO Group, the company that sued IBM over copyright infringement of its UNIX code in 2003, has announced that it has filed a formal 'Reorganisation Plan' and disclosure statement with the bankruptcy court in Delaware, the United States, on January 8, 2009.

As part of the proposed reorganisation plan, SCO intends to conduct a public auction to secure additional operating funds and investment in its OpenServer product line as well as its mobile business.

The company believes that the auction will maximise the value of an asset sale and will ensure the ongoing development of these businesses. Several investment groups have expressed interest in acquiring assets via the public auction, claims the company. Jeff Hunsaker, president and chief operating officer, SCO operations, said, "One goal of this approach is to separate the legal defence of our intellectual property rights from our core product business. The auction process is expected to ensure that the future revenue from the OpenServer and mobile businesses stays with those assets and provides an uninterrupted path forward for our customers, products and employees," said Hunsaker.

The plan is subject to the Bankruptcy Court approval. A hearing for the approval of the disclosure statement is scheduled before the Bankruptcy Court on February 25, 2009.

